LS3: Dealing with Customers

Technical Support - Solving Problems

Situation: You are a member of the Customer Support team at Entavia ERP.
→ **You write a troubleshooting guide for part of your ERP system.**

1 Understanding support plans

The support packages offered by Entavia to their customers have recently been updated. You read a description of them and who they relate to.

The support available to users depends on their subscription plan or the version of the software they are using:

Essentials plan
Designed for organizations that need streamlined access to core/basic ERP functionalities, such as managing inventory, tracking expenses and generating standard financial reports. Includes access to online tutorials and email support for basic troubleshooting.

Growth plan
Offers advanced analytics, customizable workflows and multi-location tracking to support expanding operations. Includes a dedicated support manager and faster response times for critical issues.

Professional plan
Provides industry-specific modules, such as project management, customer billing and compliance tracking. Includes live chat support and on-demand training for team members.

Premium collaboration suite
Focused on bringing teams together across multiple locations with tools for document sharing, workflow automation and real-time communication. Comes with 24/7 priority support and access to a library of best practices.

Global operations package
Includes multi-currency support, intercompany accounting and compliance tools for international trade. Offers dedicated consultants for implementation and quarterly system health checks.

Sustainability plan
Provides tools to monitor energy usage, manage green initiatives and ensure compliance with environmental regulations. Comes with integration support for IoT devices and dashboards for sustainability reporting.

Community-driven edition
A budget-friendly option with access to an active user community, open-source plugins and forums for self-service support. Paid add-ons are available for specific features or one-time expert consultations.

A **Which support package suits each type of company below?**

1 businesses that need to share information across different locations
2 small businesses, charities or non-government organisations with in-house IT expertise
3 businesses prioritizing eco-friendly operations
4 businesses just starting with ERP systems and needing only the basics
5 multinational businesses managing complex operations across countries or regions
6 businesses experiencing rapid growth and requiring scalable solutions
7 companies with specialized needs for their industry

B **Discuss the reasons for your answers in 1A with a partner.**

2 Describing problems and symptoms

You read some FAQs that are used to diagnose and confirm some common issue with Entavia's CRM.

Question 1: Why can't I access my customer records?
Users may experience difficulty loading or viewing customer data in the CRM.

Question 2: Why aren't leads or opportunities syncing with the CRM?
Automatic synchronization between the ERP and CRM modules may fail.

Question 3: Why am I unable to update customer contact details?
Issues may appear when saving changes to customer profiles.

Question 4: Why am I receiving duplicate entries for customers or leads?
The system may create multiple entries for the same customer or lead.

Question 5: Why are some emails not being sent or received in the CRM system?
The email integration may be experiencing connectivity issues or misconfigured settings.

A Read the FAQs above and match the common symptoms (a–e) to the questions (1–5).

a Users often receive an alert stating 'Changes could not be saved'. Typical signs include updated fields reverting to their previous values after attempting to save.
b Users may report that outgoing emails remain in the 'Draft' or 'Outbox' folder without being sent. Typical signs include reports of missing incoming emails that should have appeared in the CRM communication logs.
c Users may see an error message such as 'Record not found'. This issue is characterized by pages taking a long time to load or remaining unresponsive.
d Users may notice duplicate records appearing in search results with identical or slightly varied information. Typical signs include frequent 'Duplicate record detected' notifications when entering new data.
e Users could notice that new leads entered in the ERP are not appearing in the CRM. This issue is characterized by a 'Sync error: Unable to establish connection' notification.

Identifying the issue
If you encounter the following error message: '…',
The issue may appear as …

Common symptoms
You may notice …
This issue is characterized by …
Typical signs include …

B Write some FAQs for the following common errors for Entavia's inventory module using the clues provided and phrases from the language box.

1 Q: Why can't I update stock levels?
difficulty adjusting inventory quantities in the system
Common symptoms:
- error message 'Unable to update stock levels'
- fields freezing or not accepting new inputs

2 Q: Why are inventory reports showing incorrect totals?
incorrect calculations of stock levels in reports
Common symptoms:
- discrepancies between report totals and physical stock counts
- negative stock values appearing in reports

3 Q: Why are items missing from the inventory search results?
items not appearing in search results despite existing in the database
Common symptoms:
- error message 'No results found'
- known items failing to appear in search queries

4 Q: Why is the system generating duplicate product entries?
creation of multiple records for the same product
Common symptoms:
- duplicate entries appearing in the inventory list
- notifications 'Duplicate record detected'

3 Offering solutions

You listen to a colleague helping a customer to solve a problem with their ERP system.

A Before you listen, find the German translation for each of these words and phrases.

1 to generate a report
2 to reconcile payments
3 ledger
4 reconciliation screen
5 data sync
6 journal entry
7 posted
8 to reverse an entry
9 reversing transaction
10 to unlock

Confirming the symptoms
Just to confirm, are you experiencing …?

Offering clear solutions
You can resolve this by either … or …
There are two ways to fix this issue: …

Alternative solutions
If this does not work, you might also consider …
Alternatively, you can try …

26 **B Listen to the dialogue and complete the gaps with the missing phrases.**

1 ___, are you experiencing an issue where the report starts loading but doesn't complete.
2 ___ this by clearing your report filters.
3 If this does not work, ___ reducing the date range for the report
4 Can ___ – the missing transactions ones that were recently uploaded, or do they appear in the ledger but not in the reconciliation screen?
5 A fix ___ is to refresh the data sync.
6 and if that doesn't work, ___ checking the upload log.
7 Got it. ___ , are you receiving a notification saying, 'Editing locked for posted entries'?
8 This is a common restriction for financial accuracy. One ___ is by using the 'Reverse entry' option.
9 If this doesn't work, ___ checking with your system administrator.

4 Writing a troubleshooting guide

Now it is time for you to create an FAQ page for some common Supply Chain Management (SCM) module issues.

A Use a chatbot / LLM to find some causes, symptoms and solutions for the following common issues from popular ERP systems.

– Problem 1: Inventory levels not updating automatically
– Problem 2: Delayed purchase order approvals
– Problem 3: Missing shipment tracking information

B Write an FAQ that does the following:

– identifies the issue the customer is having
– confirms the symptom
– offers a clear solution
– gives an alternative

Make sure the language used is clear and concise.

PROJECT

Creating a customer support video
Find a customer support or FAQ page for some of your favourite software and learn what the most common issues are and how to solve them.
Create a short video that could be provided to customers explaining how to troubleshoot the most common problems.